



YOUR SMILE CONFIDENCE PROFILE

How to time a smile around a date

Working backwards from a wedding, a reunion, or a set of photographs: what each treatment needs in weeks, what can be done quickly, and the mistake almost everyone makes with timing.

The Moment-Maker · A Smile Confidence guide · General information, not dental advice

Work backwards, not forwards

If there is a date on your calendar, that date is the design constraint, and the single most useful thing you can do is count backwards from it rather than forwards from today. Cosmetic dentistry has waiting built into it, and most of the waiting is not optional.

Rough shape of it. Whitening takes a couple of weeks of wear plus a settling period before any permanent shade is matched to it. Bonding can often be done in a single visit. Veneers usually run across several appointments with laboratory time in between, and then a review once you have lived with them. Alignment, if it is part of the plan, is measured in months rather than weeks.

The mistake is arriving six weeks out asking for the full plan. What happens then is that steps get compressed, the settling and review appointments disappear, and the result is finished under time pressure. A good cosmetic dentist will tell you that and offer you the version that fits the runway you actually have.

IMAGE TO PLACE

A calendar or diary on a desk in the practice, shallow depth of field. Signals timing without resorting to a stock wedding photograph.

Six things to do once you have a date

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 Book the consultation earlier than feels necessary

Six months out is comfortable for most plans, three is workable for many, and six weeks limits you to the quicker options. The consultation itself costs you nothing, so the early one is free information.

2 Ask what is achievable in your specific runway

Not what is possible in general. Bring the date to the first appointment and ask for the plan that fits it, including what would have to be dropped.

3 Put whitening first in the sequence

It has to happen before permanent work is shade-matched, and the colour needs time to stabilise before that match is taken. This alone dictates a lot of the schedule.

4 Protect a review appointment near the end

Not the last week. Build in time to come back and say something is not quite right, because that appointment is where small adjustments happen.

5 Do not schedule anything permanent in the final fortnight

Leave a buffer. Things occasionally need a second visit, and you do not want that landing the day before.

6 Think about the photographs specifically

If the point is how you look in pictures, say so and ask to see the proposed result photographed rather than only in the mirror. They read differently.

If the date is very close, say so at the start rather than at the end. Whitening and bonding can achieve a surprising amount in a short window, and a good plan for six weeks looks nothing like a rushed version of a plan for six months. An honest short plan serves you well. A compressed long one rarely does.

Signs the timing is being taken seriously

- Someone asked for your date before proposing a plan
- The sequence was explained in weeks, not just in visits
- A review appointment was built in rather than added if needed
- You were told plainly what would not fit in the time available
- Nobody promised the full plan inside a window that cannot hold it

IMAGE TO PLACE

Dr. Mehta talking a patient through a plan on a screen, both looking at it together.

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

A schedule with room in it is a schedule that can absorb the small adjustment nobody predicted. That is easier to offer when the day is not already full, which is one of the practical consequences of running two chairs rather than ten.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

IMAGE TO PLACE

The two-chair room shot end to end, showing how small the practice actually is.

Bring these to your consultation

Thirty minutes goes a lot further with a couple of specifics in hand. Turning up with none of them is fine too.

1 The date, and what happens on it

A wedding where you are the one being photographed all day is a different brief from a reunion. Say which it is.

2 Any photographs already booked

Engagement shoots and pre-event portraits often come weeks before the day itself, which moves the real deadline earlier than people realise.

3 What you want to stop thinking about

The specific thing you do not want on your mind during the moment. That is the actual goal, and it is worth naming.

Thirty minutes, free, plus a preview of your smile

Bring your date. Dr. Mehta will tell you what genuinely fits it, show you a rendered preview of a possible result, and be straight about anything that would need more runway than you have.

Book your free 30 minutes

4600 Crowchild Trail NW, Suite 505, Calgary · (587) 327-8651

Nothing is done to your teeth at this appointment, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about cosmetic dental treatment. It is not dental advice, it is not a treatment plan, and it is not a comment on any other practice. What is achievable for your teeth depends on an in-person examination, and results differ from person to person. Any images you are shown are an illustration of a possible outcome, not a promise of one. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.